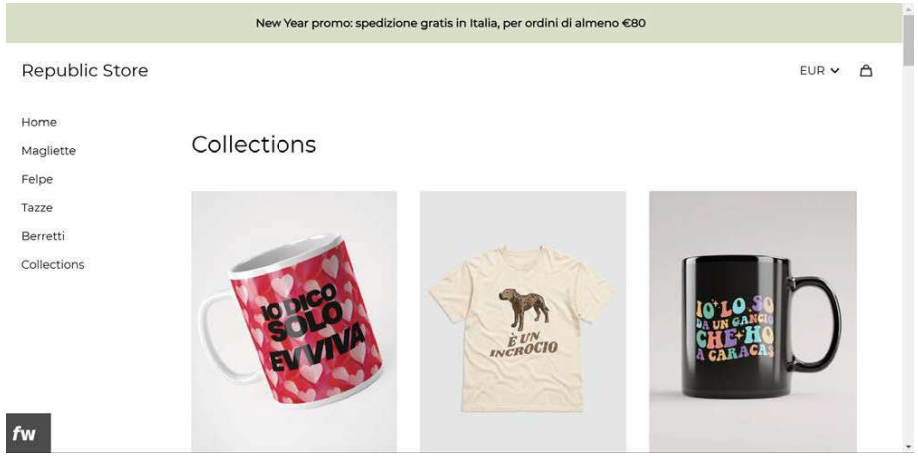
# MERCH ILLUSTRATION

MERCH ILLUSTRATION FOR
*I BELLISSIMI DI ZANZARA REPUBLIC*

Youtube channel of *I Bellissimi di Zanzara Republic*
https://www.youtube.com/@BellissimiZanzaraRepublic

**Client:** *I Bellissimi di Zanzara Republic* - A popular Italian YouTube channel that offers a mix of humor, satire, and cultural commentary. The channel is known for its distinctive tone and niche audience appeal, making it a unique hub for fans seeking entertainment with a sharp and ironic edge.

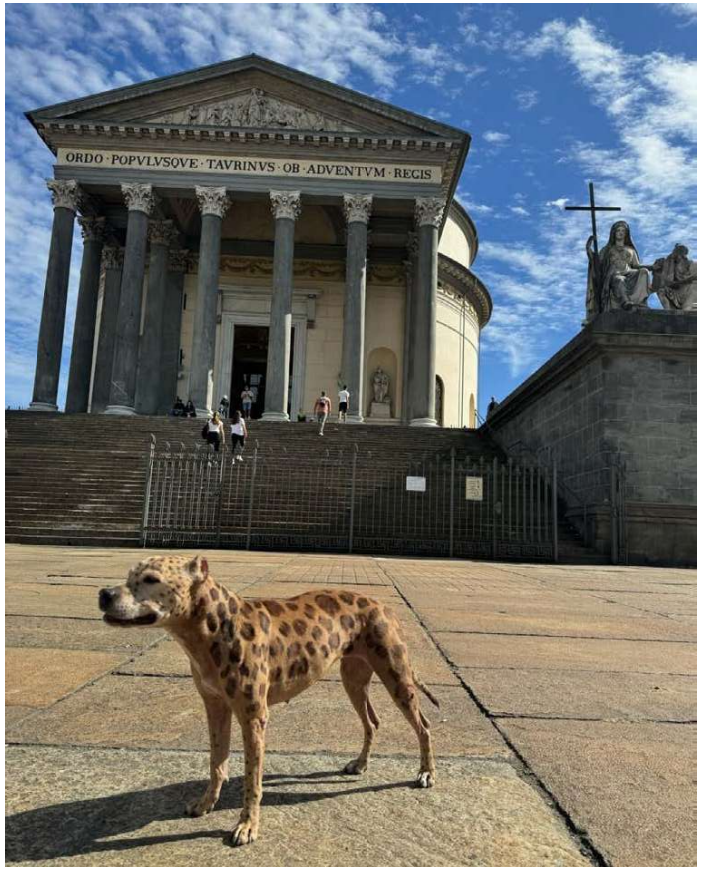
**Project Description:** I was commissioned to create an illustration for the YouTube channel's official merchandise shop, which is hosted on *Fourthwall*. The illustration was to be featured on a t-shirt and sweatshirt, and it became one of the shop's best-selling items.




The merch store on *Fourthwall*
https://i-bellissimi-di-zanzara-rep-shop.fourthwall.com/en-eur/

# ABOUT THE SUBJECT: THE CANEPARDO

The design centers on the Canepardo, a viral internet phenomenon and cultural meme. The Canepardo is a hybrid creature—a mix of dog and leopard—whose existence sparks curiosity and humor. It gained attention through social media platforms like TikTok, where discussions about its authenticity and peculiar appearance became wildly popular. For this project, the client provided a reference image of the Canepardo and requested the inclusion of the phrase "*è un incrocio*" ("it's a hybrid"), encapsulating the satirical tone of the design.




Reference image I was given
https://www.instagram.com/p/DAiej2FIAN7/?img_index=2



# THE CREATIVE PROCESS

The client's vision was clear: create a vibrant, humorous, and detailed vector illustration of the Canepardo that could resonate with the channel's audience. I started by analyzing the reference image provided, taking note of its unique features and how best to emphasize its hybrid nature. I also incorporated the client's chosen text, "*è un incrocio*," ensuring it complemented the overall visual style.

## 2. Illustration in Adobe Illustrator:

Using *Adobe Illustrator*, I crafted the vector illustration:

**Line Work:** I focused on clean, bold lines to capture the Canepardo's distinct features, such as its leopard spots and canine anatomy.

**Color Palette:** I selected a vivid yet balanced color scheme, carefully selected from the reference image, ensuring a close resemblance as well as enhancing the design's playful and striking appeal.

**Typography Design:** For "*è un incrocio*," I experimented with fonts and layouts to find the perfect style that matched the illustration's energy. I settled on a bold, slightly quirky typeface (Shrikhand), to which I then added a wave effect to maintain the humor and lightheartedness.

## 3. Integration into Merchandise:

I used the Fourthwall shop merch creator to bring the design to life on t-shirts and sweatshirts:

**Placement and Scale:** I ensured the illustration was scaled appropriately for maximum visibility and impact on the garments.

**Base Colour:** I chose ivory / sand as the base colour, to ensure a base light enough to enhance the illustration, but also that matched the illustration's colour palette, to ensure aesthetics.

**Product Variants:** The design was applied to t-shirts and sweatshirts, as well as hoodies. However the placement of the text has been changed, offering variety to fans of the channel.

## RESULTS AND RECEPTION:

The final products were launched in the channel's merch store and quickly became a fan favorite. The humorous and vibrant design resonated with the audience, and the Canepardo-themed merchandise became one of the top-selling options.

## KEY TAKEAWAYS:

**Collaboration:** Working with I Bellissimi di Zanzara Republic allowed me to merge their unique brand voice with my creative expertise.

**Design Versatility:** Adobe Illustrator's flexibility was instrumental in achieving a high-quality, scalable design suitable for merchandise.

**E-Commerce Integration:** The Fourthwall shop merch creator provided an intuitive platform for translating digital artwork into tangible products.

This project exemplified the power of combining humor, internet culture, and sharp design to create merchandise that not only represents a brand but also deeply connects with its community.

# EXTENDED MERCH DESIGNS

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Following the success of the Canepardo-themed t-shirt and sweatshirt designs for the *I Bellissimi di Zanzara Republic* YouTube channel, I expanded the merchandise collection with additional products featuring new and complementary designs.

These additions further aligned with the humor, creativity, and branding of the channel, catering to its engaged fanbase.

# CANEPARDO-THEMED MERCHANDISE

## Mug Designs

Building on the Canepardo illustration and text ("*è un incrocio*") I previously created, I designed three distinct mug options for the *I Bellissimi di Zanzara Republic Fourthwall* shop.

These designs offer variety and versatility while maintaining the bold and humorous aesthetic that fans expect.

### 01

A sleek black base featuring the Canepardo illustration on one side and the text on the opposite side.

### 02

A clean white base with the same layout as Mug 1.

### 03

A playful design on a white base, where the "*è un incrocio*" text is positioned centrally, surrounded by multiple small Canepardo illustrations.

## Baseball Hat Design

For fans looking for wearable merchandise, I created a Stone-colored baseball hat featuring:

- The Canepardo illustration embroidered on the front, providing a high-quality and durable representation of the design.
- The text "è un incrocio" embroidered on the left side for added personality and brand alignment.

The minimalist design and neutral color choice ensure broad appeal while keeping the focus on the playful and iconic Canepardo theme.

# "IO DICO SOLO EVVIVA" DESIGN

## To diversify the merchandise line, the YouTuber requested a dual-typography text illustration:

The phrase "*io dico solo*" was set in the Aktiv Grotesk font, with a clean and modern black typeface.

The word "*evviva*" was styled larger, italicized, and slanted, creating a sense of movement and excitement.

This phrase is a famous quote by Italian journalist Vittorio Feltri, known for his sharp and often humorous commentary. Its inclusion in the merchandise resonates with fans of I Bellissimi di Zanzara Republic who appreciate satirical and iconic cultural references.

## These text illustrations were used to create several merchandise items:

### Mug Design

A black base mug where "*io dico solo*" is written on the front, and "*evviva*" is prominently displayed on the back in bold, italicized form.

### T-shirt Design

A charcoal-colored t-shirt with the same typography, ensuring versatility for fans who prefer lightweight apparel.

### Sweatshirt Designs

Four variations (black, navy, dark heather, and red) with:

- "*io dico solo*" subtly placed on the front, in the top left corner.
- "*evviva*" written large and slanted along the left sleeve, creating a bold and dynamic statement.

# "È FATTUALE" DESIGN

For this request, I created a new text illustration featuring "*è fattuale*."

This phrase is a notable quote by Italian journalist and radio host David Parenzo. It embodies his energetic and positive style, making it a perfect fit for the lively and humorous branding of the merchandise. Fans of the channel will immediately recognize and connect with this playful nod to his signature expression.

Using the Keep On Truckin font, I applied a wave effect in Adobe Illustrator to create a dynamic and retro-inspired look.

The design was applied to a black-base mug, keeping the focus on the bold typography while ensuring it fits seamlessly within the shop's merchandise aesthetic.

## KEY TAKEAWAYS

This expanded collection demonstrates a seamless integration of humor, typography, and branding, further cementing the unique identity of *I Bellissimi di Zanzara Republic*. Each piece was designed with the fanbase in mind, offering variety and style while staying true to the channel's playful and creative spirit.

**These designs not only celebrate the channel's humor but also reflect its strong connection with the audience, ensuring the merchandise resonates with their tastes and expectations.**